

Opportunities and obstacles

A major chunk of the e-learning business is, in fact, located squarely on the internet with little or no hardware device components involved. The 'Bring Your Own Device' or 'BYOD' model of software-oriented services (SaaS) is a further driver of the industry, promoting local innovation and investment in the market. Within this model of enterprise, consumers are offered the ability to use existing devices such as mobiles and tablets to directly access the e-learning services via the internet. A record number of start-ups within India are looking to this growing market as a lucrative opportunity within which to create and sell new products.

The proven ability of e-learning for adults has long been understood, but within this existing segment, e-learning for children is a relatively new field especially with its mobility aspects. With the BYOD SaaS model in place, which uses apps to service the consumers, the wealth of options tremendously increases. And as mobile technologies become increasingly powerful, the idea of using these mini-supercomputers as platforms for e-learning is becoming increasingly exciting. Current market research shows that along with China, Japan and South Korea, India is projected to be a top consumer of mobile technologies in the next two years on a global scale.

Most professionals and companies involved in this industry don't consider technology, infrastructure and literacy to be their biggest obstacles. Given the naturally expansive access to cheaper computing devices, subsidised devices from governments, as well as the expanding internet infrastructure, the key worry for e-learning business is the content. The need to develop culturally appropriate content that's engaging, informative and evolving is the key goal of the industry at the current time. There's a great deal of interest from

venture capitalists who are pouring in billions to discover the right mix of quality content from start-ups.

Clearly, the biggest contender in this segment for the year 2015 is Google. The company has announced plans to target under-13 kids with new products



Help your kids stay safe online